GRADE 8 · TEACHER GUIDE

How to Run This Year

Routines, pacing, FAQ, and the calibration of Cash's voice.

Year theme: Measure, Improve, Operate Smarter

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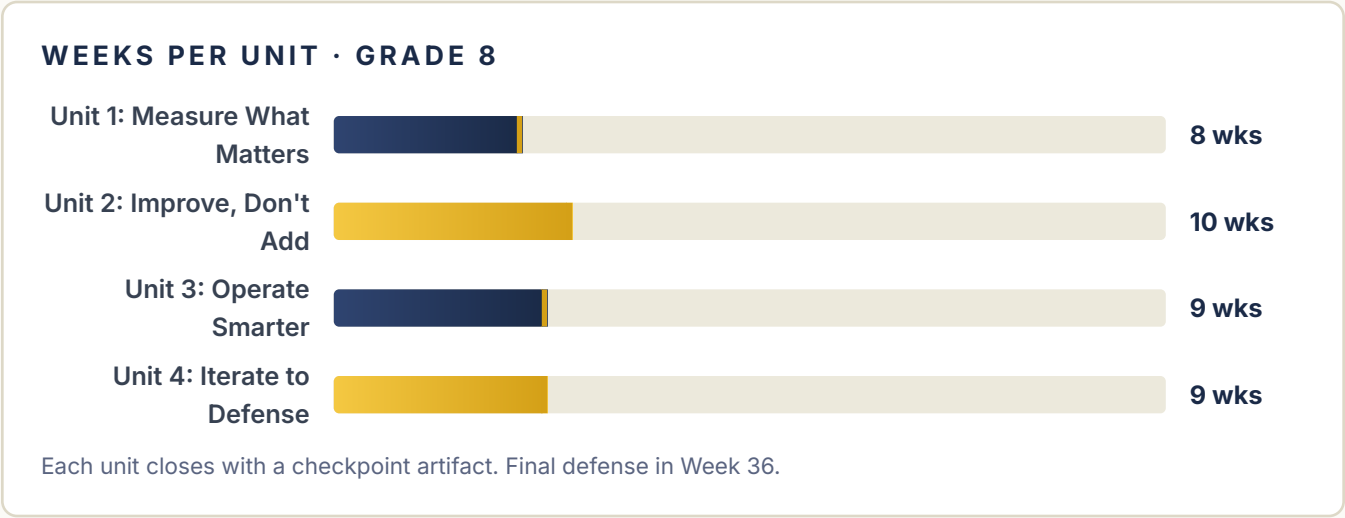
YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.



36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 8 · TEACHER GUIDE

How to Run This Year

A little less wrong, every week.

For: middle-school classroom teachers (typically math, ELA, social studies, business/CTE, or a dedicated entrepreneurship period), homeschool parents teaching the curriculum, and after-school program leads. **Companion to:** Grade 8 Curriculum Book, Lesson Plans, Student Activity Book, Cash Video Scripts, and Parent Guide.

How this year is built (and why)

"Which people, and how do you know?"

— CASH

Grade 8 of Cash to Company is the operating year. Where Grade 7 taught students to know their customer (with a customer persona and per-customer math), Grade 8 teaches them to operate on top of that knowledge — to run an idea through a structured ideation funnel, model break-even with linear equations, run a 3-day A/B test on marketing, plan a 4-week sprint, track variance, and complete a Plan-Do-Study-Act cycle. The Capstone is the Operate-Smarter Venture, which students refine across the year.

The pedagogical bones come from the same three traditions as Grade 7:

- **Understanding by Design.** Big ideas, essential questions, and a year-end performance task drive the planning. Lessons feed the Capstone, not the other way around.
- **Workshop model.** Mini-lesson (10–15 min) → guided work (20–30 min) → confer + close (10 min). Students do most of their thinking on their own work most days.
- **Routines, not heroics.** A small set of weekly routines keeps cognitive load on content, not structure.

What's new in Grade 8: the math gets crisper (linear equations and sensitivity tables), the experiments are more rigorous (named hypotheses, named biases, lift computations), and the operating discipline appears (variance, PDSA, peer feedback rounds, privacy/safety risk plans).

Classroom routines

These run all year. Establish them in the first three weeks and protect them.

Monday — Cash + the Question

A 5-minute Cash video (or printed transcript) introduces the week's question. Students respond to a one-prompt opener in the Capstone Journal. Whole-class share-out: 2–3 students.

Wednesday — Work Block

The longest block of the week, 45–60 minutes, dedicated to the Capstone. Mini-lesson (10–15) → independent or pair work (30–40) → 5-minute close. Teacher confers with 4–6 students per block in 3-minute one-on-ones.

Friday — Showcase + Stuck

15–20-minute share. Three or four students share progress; one student shares "where I'm stuck." Class generates suggestions using the peer feedback round frame (this year's version): "What's working / What's confusing / One change I'd try."

Daily — the Vocabulary Spine

A single-page running glossary at the back of the notebook. Students add 1–3 terms per week with a Frayer entry for "weight-bearing" terms (this year: SCAMPER, break-even, PDSA, variance). Tuesday/Thursday have 5-minute vocabulary openers.

Bi-weekly — the Math Workshop

Every other Wednesday, the Work Block has a math-heavy frame. Students bring their break-even calculators, sensitivity tables, lift computations, or variance tables. The workshop format scales — students work, teacher circulates, peer-debug.

Pedagogy at this grade band

- **Concrete, then abstract.** Even at 8th grade, students benefit from running the math on real or carefully simulated numbers before generalizing. Use real local prices, real platform fees.
- **Talk before write.** Most 13–14-year-olds know more than they can put on paper at first try. Pair-share before journal write.
- **Visible thinking.** The Vocabulary Spine, Capstone Journal, wall-posted SCAMPER charts, and pinned A/B test posters make student thinking observable.
- **Tests over slogans.** When a student announces a marketing claim or a pricing strategy, the move is "what test would tell you?" — every time. By Week 12, students will ask each other.
- **Variance is data.** When a 4-week plan misses, the writeup is the assignment. Hidden variance is the failure; named variance is the learning. Reward the writeup, not the magic match.

- **Identity-aware.** A 13-year-old is figuring out who they are publicly. Capstones can signal something true about them — coach against ventures that exclude classmates or trade on body-image messaging.

Assessment philosophy

"Honest claims build customers who come back. Tricks build customers who feel taken."

— CASH

Assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the student do the work the standard names?** Real ideation flow, real math, real test, real plan, real variance writeup, real risk plan — not pretend versions.
2. **Did they think about it?** Reflection prompts in every checkpoint memo. The Reflection Writing Rubric is used on the Capstone Journal portfolio at year end.

Use the program's analytic rubrics (Rubric Bank) for Capstone checkpoints. The five rubrics map to Grade 8 work as follows:

Rubric	Used for
Business Plan Rubric	Unit 1 Ideation Pack; Unit 4 Final PDSA Pack
Pitch Presentation Rubric	Final Capstone Defense
Budget Project Rubric	Unit 2 Break-Even Pack
Customer Research Rubric	Unit 3 Marketing Test Pack (interpretation/persona linkage)
Reflection Writing Rubric	Capstone Journal portfolio + end-of-unit memos

Use simple holistic checks (3-2-1, exit tickets, thumbs-up) during weekly work. Avoid the trap of grading effort or neatness — read for evidence of the standard.

A typical assessment cadence

Cadence	Form	Stakes
Daily	Exit ticket or work-block confer	Low — formative
Weekly	Capstone Journal entry	Low–medium — counts toward habit grade
Bi-weekly	Vocabulary check (10 terms)	Low — formative

Cadence	Form	Stakes
End of unit	Capstone checkpoint with rubric	Medium-high — rubric-graded
End of year	Final Capstone Defense	Highest — full-year synthesis

Pacing — week by week

The pacing below is a default. Adjust to your actual calendar (assume ~36 weeks). Each week needs roughly 90–120 instructional minutes for Cash to Company; the Capstone Journal homework is 10–15 minutes of writing.

Unit 1 — From idea to test (Weeks 1–8)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
1	Course launch + Cash V1 ("From Idea to Test")	Set norms; "Day 1 Improvement Bet"	Choose Capstone direction
2	Pick the Capstone	Returning students review Grade 7 work; new students do "Skills + Hobbies + Needs" recycle	Lock Capstone topic
3	Divergent thinking; SCAMPER intro	SCAMPER applied to a school-cafeteria problem	Practice SCAMPER
4	SCAMPER + HMW (full lesson)	SCAMPER on Capstone; 3 HMW statements	Generate 7+ ideas
5	Convergent thinking	Criteria selection; idea scoring	Score 10 ideas; pick 3 finalists
6	Cash V5 ("Personas Through the Funnel")	Connect ideation to known customer	Draft Page 4 of Ideation Pack
7	Value Levers — In-N-Out vs. McDonald's	Read case; lever-spot Capstone	Lever-spot complete
8	**Checkpoint 1** — Ideation Pack	Studio Day; gallery walk + peer share	Submit Ideation Pack (graded)

Unit 2 — The break-even truth (Weeks 9–18)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
9	Cash V2 ("The Break-Even Truth") + optional pivot window	Pivot decision (kept or new venture)	Confirm Capstone or pivot
10	Recycle: contribution margin (Grade 7)	Quick refresher; problem set	Compute CM per unit
11	Fixed cost vs. variable cost (recycled)	Sort game; matching	Identify fixed costs
12	Linear-equation break-even	Equation setup; algebra solve	Compute break-even units
13	Break-even calculator template	Build full calculator (paper or sheet)	Complete calculator
14	Reasonableness check	Compare break-even to interview-evidence demand	Realism check
15	Sensitivity intro	2-scenario worst/best	Build sensitivity table
16	Most-sensitive input	Identify and defend the lever input	Name most-sensitive input
17	Memo writing	1-page Break-Even Memo draft	Draft memo
18	**Checkpoint 2** — Break-Even Pack	Three-minute math defenses	Submit Break-Even Pack (graded)

Unit 3 — Marketing as experiment (Weeks 19–28)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
19	Cash V3 ("Marketing Is an Experiment") + optional pivot	Two-page case: a tested vs. untested ad campaign	Confirm Capstone
20	Persuasion techniques (recycled from G7)	Ad analysis; vocab refresh	Spot 5 techniques
21	A/B test design	Three rules; one-variable discipline	Pick variable to test
22	Build two posters		Build A and B

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
		Same product, different message	
23	Hypothesis + bias	Write hypothesis; predict lift; name bias	Hypothesis card filed
24	Run Day 1 of test	Tally throughout the day	Test live
25	Days 2–3	Continue tally	Complete tally
26	Cash V6 ("What Could Your A/B Test Not Tell You?") + lift	Compute lift; honest 2-sentence analysis	Lift computed
27	First PDSA cycle on the message	Plan-Do-Study-Act on the marketing	PDSA cycle drafted
28	**Checkpoint 3** — Marketing Test Pack	Pitch-back + peer panel	Submit Marketing Test Pack (graded)

Unit 4 — Operate smarter (Weeks 29–36)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
29	Cash V4 ("Operate Smarter") + optional pivot	4-week project plan kickoff	Draft 4-week plan
30	Owners, deadlines, milestones	Plan refinement; RACI recycle	Plan complete
31	Variance — when plan and reality disagree	Variance computation; 1-page writeup	Variance writeup
32	Cash V7 ("Variance Is the Story") + peer feedback round	"What's working / What's confusing / One change I'd try" — both directions	Peer round complete
33	Privacy + safety risk plan	Identify 1 privacy + 1 safety risk; 3-step mitigation each	Risk plan complete
34	Final PDSA cycle	Run cycle; document Plan-Do-Study-Act	Final PDSA complete
35	Capstone defense prep	Storyboard the defense; build slides/ poster	Defense ready
36			

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
	Final Capstone Defense + Cash V8	Public presentation + year-end reflection	Deliver the defense

FAQ

Q: I have ELA, not business background. Can I teach this? A: Yes. The lesson plans script the moves; the Cash videos introduce concepts; you become the chief evidence-norm-enforcer ("which people, and how do you know? what's your bet, and what would tell you you're wrong?"). The math in Grade 8 is 8th-grade math: linear equations and basic data interpretation. If you're shaky on the linear-equation lessons, coordinate with the math teacher — many will gladly co-teach a session for the cross-curricular win.

Q: We don't have a class store or classroom economy. Can students still do this? A: Yes. Many ventures don't require currency exchange — content, services, events, repair, tutoring. For ventures that do, simulated transactions are fine for the Capstone.

Q: My students didn't take Grade 7 Cash to Company. Can they catch up? A: Yes. Week 2 has a backfill option — students new to the program complete a compressed customer-persona + per-customer-math activity (drawn from Grade 7 Activity Book Activities 1.7 + 2.4) before the SCAMPER work begins. Allow 1 extra week for new-to-program students.

Q: A student wants to do an online venture (Etsy, Instagram, TikTok account). How do I handle privacy? A: Unit 4's privacy/safety risk plan is required for all ventures. For online ventures, surface the platform's age requirement (most US platforms are 13+), the school's policy on student-run accounts, and the family's role in account decisions. The risk plan must include account-management rules and a parent-loop step. The curriculum doesn't endorse or block online ventures — it requires that the risks be named and mitigated.

Q: A student wants to do a venture that feels off (gambling-like, weight-loss, exclusionary). A: Use the optional pivot windows. Coach early ("What about this idea is sitting wrong with me?"). The Ethics, Safety, and Legal strand exists precisely for this — and at Grade 8, the privacy/safety risk plan is the formal moment to surface concerns.

Q: Some of my students don't have stable internet at home. A: Run the curriculum print-first. The Cash videos have transcripts; the break-even calculator has a paper version; the A/B test can be poster-only; the PDSA template is a single sheet. The optional spreadsheet versions are explicitly optional.

Q: How do I assess fairly when students choose different ventures? A: The rubrics are content-agnostic. They measure ideation rigor, math accuracy + sensitivity, claim integrity + test honesty, and operating discipline (variance + PDSA) — not how cool the business is. A tutoring service and a snack venture can both score 4s if the work is rigorous.

Q: What if a student wants to talk about real family money problems triggered by these lessons? A: Refer to the school counselor. Don't try to handle it inside the lesson. The curriculum is designed to leave private home finance off the table.

Q: Do I need to give grades on the Cash videos? A: No. The Cash videos are concept anchors. Use them for opening discussions and reflection prompts. The Capstone checkpoints carry the grade weight.

Q: My class has 30 students. The peer feedback round seems impossible. A: Pair students randomly. The round is "what's working / what's confusing / one change I'd try" in both directions, so each pair gets two rounds. 30 students = 15 pairs, each running a 10–12 minute round. Rotate one round per Friday for two weeks.

Q: How does the math teacher fit in? A: Lesson 5 (linear-equation break-even) and Lesson 6 (sensitivity) are direct CCSS-Math 8.EE.C.7 + 8.F.B.4 + 8.SP.A.1 work. Coordinate with the math teacher to either co-teach the lessons or align timing — students appreciate seeing the same equation type appear in both rooms.

Q: What's the minimum I can do if I'm out of time some weeks? A: Protect Wednesday's Work Block. Skip Monday or Friday before you skip Wednesday. The Capstone is the spine; everything else is helpful but not load-bearing.

Common pitfalls

"Most adults skip this. You won't."

— CASH

- **The hand-waved break-even.** A student says "my break-even is small, I'll hit it." Push: "What's your evidence — from your Grade 7 persona work or recent interviews — that you can find that many customers? What's the realistic per-week number?"
- **The fudged A/B test.** A student inflates Message A's count because they like A. The rubric explicitly rewards small-but-real over big-but-fake. Coach: "What's your test telling you that you don't want to hear? Listen to that part."

- **The "magic match" plan.** A student's actuals match their plan exactly. This is suspicious and almost always indicates loose tracking. Push: "Either your plan was perfect or you're not tracking at fine enough grain. Which?"
- **The sensitivity table all rosy.** A student's "worst case" is barely worse than their "best guess." Coach: "What would actually break this venture? What's a real risk?"
- **The privacy plan that says 'nothing.'** A student claims their venture has no privacy risk. Push: "What information about you, your customer, or your supplier is visible? Even your handle is information. What's the mitigation?"
- **The pivot that wasn't.** A pivot window doesn't mean "switch because your first idea was hard." It means "switch because evidence said the customer wasn't there." Make students articulate the evidence.
- **The defense that's a sales pitch.** The final defense is reflective: what I learned about my idea, my math, my test, my plan, my risk. Not a Shark Tank cosplay. Coach toward evidence and revision, not enthusiasm.

Working with the Cash mascot

Cash is a mascot, not a teacher. Do not let students treat Cash's word as authority — Cash poses questions; students answer them in evidence. If a student says "Cash said do X," redirect: "What does your evidence say?"

For voice and personality of Cash, see the Cash Mascot Style Guide. Bottom line: Cash is curious and warm but does not flatter, does not promise quick wins, and never says "everyone can be rich." See the style guide for forbidden phrases.

Working with parents and caregivers

The Parent Guide is sent home in Week 1 with a brief overview and four optional conversation starters (one per quarter). The biggest parent question this year is: "is my kid going to launch an online business that I have to monitor?" Answer: only if the family decides to. Capstones are educational. The Unit 4 privacy/safety risk plan is required regardless of whether the venture is real or hypothetical — it's a thinking exercise.

Calibration — anchor papers and inter-rater reliability

"Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal."

— CASH

Before scoring any Capstone Pack, the team should calibrate.

- For the **Ideation Pack**, pull a "3" anchor paper from a prior year (or build one from the curriculum exemplars). Score independently, then compare. Recalibrate to the anchor.
- For the **Break-Even Pack**, pull two anchors — one with full sensitivity table, one with sensitivity but realistic-only inputs. The difference between a "4" and a "3" is often the sensitivity work plus the most-sensitive-input identification.
- For the **Marketing Test Pack**, calibrate especially on "honest reporting." A pack that fudged the count is a "1" regardless of how clean the rest is; a pack that named "inconclusive" honestly can be a "4."
- For the **Final PDSA Pack**, calibrate on the variance writeup quality and the privacy/safety mitigation specificity.

Allow rubric translation. ELL students benefit from a translated rubric in their home language and a glossary of rubric terms.

A teacher self-check at end of year

Did most of my students this year:

- Run a structured ideation flow with at least 2 named techniques? (Yes/No)
- Compute break-even using a linear-equation form, with at least 2 sensitivity scenarios? (Yes/No)
- Run a 3-day A/B test with a stated hypothesis, named bias, and honest verdict? (Yes/No)
- Build a 4-week plan, track variance, and write a 1-page variance explanation? (Yes/No)
- Complete a Plan-Do-Study-Act cycle with a real change and a documented result? (Yes/No)
- Identify a privacy and a safety risk in their venture and write 3-step mitigation plans? (Yes/No)
- Give and receive structured peer feedback in both directions? (Yes/No)

If five of seven are yes, the year worked. If fewer, look at which routine slipped — usually the Wednesday Work Block, which is where the math and the variance live.

Cross-grade hand-off

At year end, archive each student's Capstone Journal and Final PDSA Pack. Grade 9's Business Model Canvas unit references this work directly: students who arrive in Grade 9 with a refined Grade 8 venture have most of the BMC's value-prop, customer, channel, and cost boxes already populated. Coordinate with Grade 9 teachers for a "warm hand-off" memo per student if possible — even a paragraph that names the Capstone topic, the lever, the break-even, and the biggest variance is high-leverage for the Grade 9 teacher.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Differentiation deep moves (Grade 8)

Advanced learners — three named extensions

1. **Sensitivity table.** For the break-even lesson, advanced students build a sensitivity table: what happens to break-even at price ±10%, variable cost ±10%, fixed cost ±10%? The variable that moves break-even most is the one to focus on.
2. **Multi-cycle PDSA.** Run two consecutive PDSA cycles on the same metric. Compare the two cycles' results. "What did Cycle 2 tell you that Cycle 1 didn't?"
3. **Privacy-risk role-play.** Advanced students role-play a kid pitching their venture to a wary parent. The parent asks the privacy/safety questions. Surfaces real conversations real founders need to have.

ELL deep moves

- **Linear-equation visual aids.** A simple graph: x-axis units sold, y-axis revenue and cost. Lines cross at break-even. The picture carries the math.
- **PDSA card with cognates.** Plan, Hacer, Estudiar, Actuar.
- **A/B test sentence stems.** "Message A got __ votes. Message B got __ votes. The winner appears to be __ because __."

IEP/504 deep moves

- **Spreadsheet template pre-built for break-even.** Student enters price, variable cost, fixed cost; spreadsheet computes break-even.
- **PDSA worksheet with one cycle pre-printed.** Student fills in the four boxes.
- **Variance write-up sentence stems.** "My plan said **. The actual result was** . The difference was __ because **. Next time I'll** ."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cash Never Says (Teacher Reference Card)

Cash never says: "Amazing!" / "Awesome!" / "Crushing it!" / "Boss up" / "Get that bag" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Financial freedom" / "Just believe" / "If you can dream it, you can do it" / "Side hustle" (use "side venture") / wealth-flexing language / anything implying wealth is mindset/hustle / anything implying low-income or unbanked families are at fault.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?" / "What would have to be true for you to be right/wrong?" / "Whats one thing youd change?"

Teacher mirror: Replace "great job!" with "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?"

Cashs three signature physical moves: (1) **Notebook Tilt**; (2) **Two-Finger Tap**; (3) **Slow Lean**.

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

> *"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."*
>
> — CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 8 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 8 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist. The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-1	Identify the components of decision-making and apply them to financial decisions.
CCSS-Math 8.SP.A.1	Construct and interpret scatter plots for bivariate measurement data.
CCSS-ELA SL.8.4	Present claims and findings, emphasizing salient points in a focused, coherent manner.
C3 D2.Eco.5.6-8	Explain ways in which money facilitates exchange.
CASEL Responsible Decision-Making	Demonstrate curiosity and open-mindedness; analyze information.
CCSS-Math 7.RP.A.3	Use proportional relationships to solve multistep ratio and percent problems.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."

— CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
-

Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Measure What Matters

Priya runs a tutoring micro-business helping 6th graders with pre-algebra. She has eight regular clients. Five say they would recommend her. Three would not. Her old metric was "hours billed." Her new metric: "would recommend."

The new metric tells a different story. Two of her three non-recommenders share the same complaint: "Sessions feel like quizzes." Priya redesigns the first 10 minutes of every session to start with what the student is stuck on, not what Priya wants to teach. Three weeks later: 7 of 8 would recommend.

What changed? Not effort. Not skill. The metric. "Would recommend" surfaced the experience. Hours billed surfaced nothing.

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

> *"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."*
>
> — CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH, GRADE 8